



A quarry in the town of Mongbwalu, Democratic Republic of Congo, where gold has been the lifeblood for over a century. Conditions are now driving an Ebola outbreak.

Mining Town Can't Escape Grip of Ebola

By DECLAN WALSH

MONGBWALU, Democratic Republic of Congo — After the local Islamic State affiliate attacked his farm, Mumbere Saidi fled to the gold mines in northeastern Democratic Republic of Congo, trekking 200 miles across one of Africa's most dangerous war zones.

He found backbreaking work in a remote mining town where he panned for gold. When times were good, Mr. Saidi, 27, sent a few dollars back to the parents he left behind. When they were bad, he struggled to feed his wife and baby daughter.

At least he felt safe, until last week, when an invisible enemy struck Mr. Saidi inside his home.

"The disease got him," said his brother, Kondu Ganda, also a miner, using a common euphemism for Ebola in a town where many avoid the word.

Behind him, Red Cross workers in white protective suits removed Mr. Saidi's body from their mud-walled home and carefully placed it in a coffin.

For over a century, gold has been the lifeblood of Mongbwalu, a remote hill town in Ituri province that draws people looking for work from across Congo and beyond. But now Mongbwalu is at the epicenter of the devastating Ebola outbreak sweeping this region, and gold is helping to drive it.

Experts now believe that the outbreak, already the third largest

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Senate Passes Migration Bill Amid Revolts

By ANNIE KARNI and ROBERT JIMISON

WASHINGTON — Senate Republicans on Friday pushed through their \$70 billion bill to fund President Trump's immigration crackdown through the remainder of his term, after beating back bipartisan efforts to add language to bar or sharply restrict a federal payout fund for his political allies.

The 52-to-47 vote early Friday morning sent the measure to the House, which was expected to move quickly to pass it.

It was a victory for the president and his party, who have been eager to spotlight their hard-line immigration stance — and Democrats' opposition to it — in the middle of an election year when their control of Congress is at stake. Senator Lisa Murkowski, Republican of Alaska, was the only Republican to oppose the measure, joining all Democrats.

But passage came only after Republican leaders quelled an internal revolt that had been simmering for weeks over recent moves by Mr. Trump that have underscored how his personal agenda is diverging sharply from his party's political interests. The divisions threatened to sink the measure and prompted several G.O.P. defections on bipartisan efforts to modify it, all of which failed in an hours-long series of back-to-back votes that stretched all day Thursday and into the predawn hours of Friday.

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Platner Could Be 'Unsettling,' Some Women Say

By KATIE GLUECK and LISA LERER

On Tuesday evening, after a whirlwind day in Washington, Graham Platner, the Democratic candidate for Senate in Maine, rushed home.

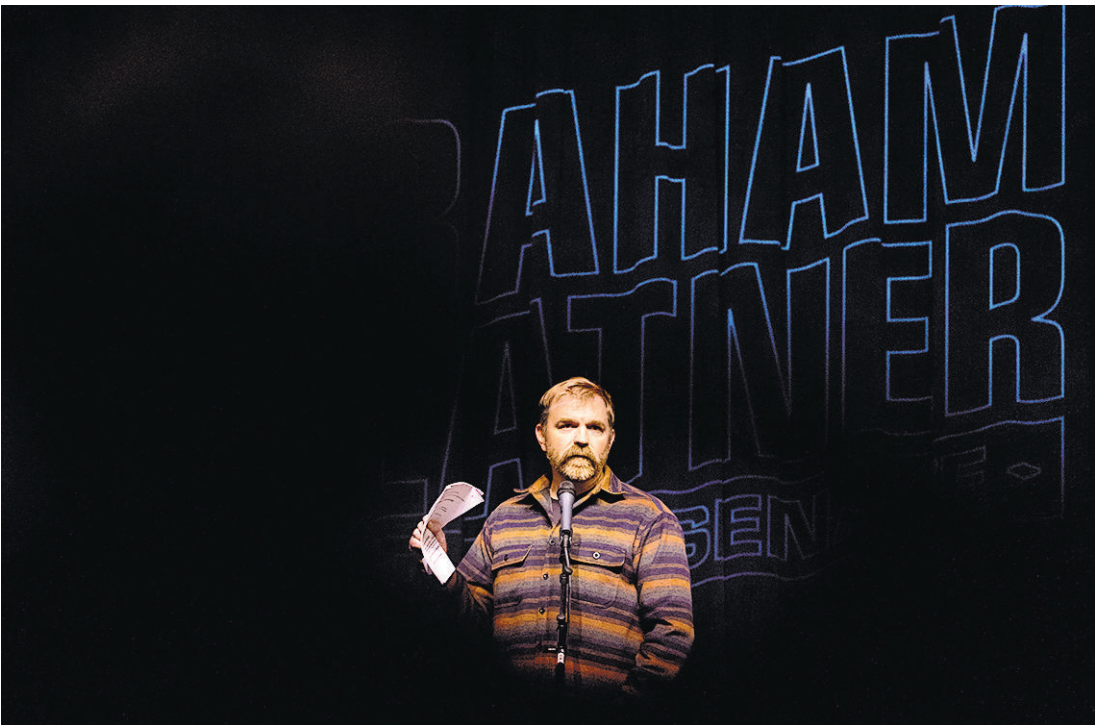
Rumors were spreading from Portland to the Potomac about Mr. Platner's messy personal life, after news reports that he had sent sexual messages to women while married. Democratic senators were pressing him about whether more damaging revelations were coming. Journalists were swarming, staking out his hometown.

Amid the turmoil, Mr. Platner with him to this day, years after their relationships ended.

But in extensive conversations over the past two months, three other women who had been romantically involved with Mr. Platner offered a far more complicated assessment, describing volatile and "toxic" relationships that were unsettling and at times emotionally wrenching.

Mr. Platner could be charming and charismatic, they recalled in interviews, but also demeaning to women and, in at least one case, even physically threatening. He drank heavily and was regularly unfaithful.

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Graham Platner has been open about struggles that he says resulted from his time in the military.

Court Orders Restart to Immigration Processing

By ZACH MONTAGUE and MADELEINE NGO

WASHINGTON — A federal judge in Rhode Island on Friday struck down a slate of immigration policies enacted by the Trump administration, writing that the measures had "placed the lives of countless individuals on hold — solely by virtue of their countries of birth."

A Backlog of More Than a Million Applicants

In a searing 135-page opinion, Judge John J. McConnell Jr. wrote that actions to lock eligible asylum seekers out of the immigration system and deny others temporary work permits had made it

functionally impossible for a broad swath of people to remain in the country. He said the measures were improperly fueled by "anti-immigration sentiments" and contrary to immigration laws.

The policies, enacted by U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services, included a global hold on asylum applications filed with the agency. U.S.C.I.S. also paused de-

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Breakthrough in Embryonic Editing Stirs Debate

By CARL ZIMMER

Scientists at Columbia University have edited the DNA of early human embryos with unprecedented accuracy, an achievement that could open the way to babies engineered with particular characteristics.

The prospect has fueled controversy for years. On the one hand, the technology might one day en-

A Pathway to Healthier Babies, or Eugenics?

able parents to safely repair disease-causing mutations in embryos. But it might also be used to select desired traits — a practice that some ethicists have argued is nothing short of eugenics.

Dieter Egli, a geneticist at Columbia University who led the research, called for a public conversation about the pros and cons of altering embryonic DNA. "As a scientist, you can provide the data for discussion, but then essentially there you stop and let others take over," he said.

With a newer technology called base editing, Dr. Egli and his col-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-8

Zelensky Writes to Putin

In an open letter, Ukraine's leader bragged of strikes inside Russia while calling for new peace talks.

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Bitter Election in Armenia

The prime minister, backed by President Trump, is facing an opponent supported by Russia's leader.

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NATIONAL A9-16

Quest for Celebrity Validation

President Trump, who has pursued fame his entire adult life, is finding that he has little power to force cultural figures to fall in line.

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Fighting a Parasite in Cattle

Texas officials said they were working with the federal government to slow the spread of the screwworm.

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BUSINESS B1-5

Hitching a Ride With SpaceX

Even Jamie Dimon plans to pitch the Elon Musk rocket company's I.P.O. as banks eye huge fees.

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OBITUARIES A17, 20

Artist and Author of 'Persepolis'

The graphic novels of Marjane Satrapi, 56, followed an Iranian girl through the nation's upheavals.

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Editor on 'Star Wars' Films

Marcia Lucas, a close collaborator with George Lucas, her second husband, won an Oscar. She was 80.

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ARTS C1-6

Revisiting a True-Crime Fable

A bully was shot dead surrounded by witnesses in Skidmore, Mo., but no one was ever prosecuted. That act of vigilante justice has inspired the Off Broadway play "Kenrex."

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Pace Gallery Downsizes

Responding to a challenging art market, the prominent venue is cutting 50 artists and 50 staff members. But the reduction does not mean it will stop taking on new artists.

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OPINION A18-19

Rachel Timoner

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THE MAGAZINE

THIS WEEKEND